Notice Management

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Overview

Customers frequently receive IRS notices, State tax notices or just general notices and don't know how to proceed. As of today, notice handling is not a core formations product but is instead being handled through HubSpot. Notices are tracked across five pipelines:

- General Notice Pipeline
- Tax Notice Pipeline
- Payroll Notice Pipeline
- PRO - Notice Pipeline
- PRO- Partner Notice Management

Most notices enter through the General Notice Pipeline and are manually triaged from there into the appropriate pipeline. Pro customers notices follow a separate path, arriving either through the Stable App or via Lettuce-created tickets.

1. **Customers have no visibility.** Once a notice is submitted, customers have no way to track what is happening with it. They follow up with their CSM repeatedly and CSMs spend unnecessary time finding out and relaying status updates rather than resolving other issues. This leaves the customers in a state of confusion and panic when that is what we are trying to solve for them.

2. **Intake is fragmented.** Notices can arrive through multiple channels like emailing their CSM, the resource center, the document center, through the slack notice channels, and more. Notices have to either be manually routed to the correct pipeline or sometimes can be automatically triaged if coming through the general notice pipeline, but there is no guarantee a notice lands in the right place.
3. **Internal communication is inefficient.** When an internal team needs something from a customer to resolve a notice, the request travels through the CSM rather than going directly to the customer. This adds an unnecessary layer of communication that extends resolution time and raises the chances of the notice coming to a dead end.

The internal workflow will not be changing. This is focused on building a customer-facing notice dashboard on top of the existing process to give customers one place to upload their notices and track their status. This will also be where internal teams can request documents/signatures needed to resolve the notice. Status updates will come from HubSpot, those updates will sync to the dashboard for customer visibility.

Problem Statement

How notices are being handled today

when a customer receives a notice, they currently have three paths to submit to Formations:

- Upload through the Resource Center
- Upload through the Document Center
- Email their CSM directly

Once submitted, notices are triaged into the correct HubSpot pipeline. Notices that come in through email require someone on the team to recognize them, log them, and route them to the right pipeline manually. There is no single intake point, no guaranteed routing, and no confirmation to the customer that their notice was received at all.

The cost of the current state

Notices get lost before they are ever worked. Three intake paths mean three places a notice can land, or fail to land. A notice sent by email depends entirely on someone seeing it and manually entering it into the correct pipeline (or it can go to the slack notice tax or payroll channel). One uploaded to the Document Center needs to manually be sorted through other documents that are not notices, and then the documents team needs to manually create a ticket and place it into the correct pipeline. There is no system-level safeguard to catch a notice that has stalled or disappeared entirely. When a deadline is missed as a result, Formations absorbs the cost, penalties, interest, and the time required to remediate a situation that should never have reached that point.

Customers have no visibility into what happens after they submit. Once a notice is in the system, customers have no way to see who is working on it, what the current status is, or whether anything is happening at all. Their only option is to contact their CSM. CSMs then have to track down the answer internally and relay it back. This is a loop that repeats every time the customer's anxiety rises.

Resolution stalls because there is no direct line between the team and the customer. When the internal team working a notice needs something from a customer for example a document, a signature, payroll credentials, confirmation of a payment, that request does not go directly to the customer. It routes through the CSM, who contacts the customer, who responds to the CSM, who forwards it back. Each handoff adds extra time. For notices with hard agency deadlines, that delay can be the difference between resolving a notice and absorbing a penalty. Customers are often confused about what is being asked of them and why, because the request has passed through an intermediary by the time it reaches them.

Proposed Work

Building a centralized “Notice Handling Management System” inside of Formations

1. Provides one clear and easy upload location
2. Automatically categorizes notice types into correct pipelines (IRS, Payroll, audit... ect)
3. Routes notices into structured workflow
4. Allows customers to track the status of their notices

5. Tracks aging tickets

Why we are solving it this way

The main goal is to provide customers a way to alleviate stress and confusion. Building notice management as a product feature, rather than a HubSpot workflow, gives us three things an enforced pipeline fix cannot:

- A customer-facing status layer: customers see what is happening with their notice in real time, which eliminates the majority of status check communications to CSMs.
- A direct document request channel: fulfillment can request documents from customers without routing through the CSM, cutting the middle man out.
- A single intake path: regardless of how a notice arrives (customer upload, CSM forward, direct email), it enters one record with one workflow attached.

Success Criteria

Customer Success

Operational Success

Business Success

User Stories

User Type 1: Customer

- As a customer, I want one clearly labeled place to upload my notice so i know it has been received and won't be lost.
- As a customer, I want an easy to understand explanation of what my notice type means so I can understand whether it is urgent and what should happen next
- As a customer, I want to see the current status of my notice without needing to reach out to anyone (CSM usually)

- As a customer, I want to know if my notice has been received, and when and if its being worked on
- As a customer, I want to know/be notified if you need additional documents from me
- As a customer, I want to know what actions are being taken on my notice and when for clarity
- As a customer, I want to be notified if I need to take an action for my notice resolution.

User Type 2: Customer Success Manager (CSM)

- As a CSM, I want to upload a notice on behalf of the customer in a singular intake method (either through spoofing customer account, or also internal admin side).
- As a CSM, I want customers to receive status updates or a way for them to track their notices so they are not contacting me for routine progress checks.

User Type 3: Fulfillment

- As part of fulfillment, I want notices routed correctly by type
- As part of fulfillment, I want clear status transitions between pipelines
- As part of fulfillment, I want required documents flagged automatically
- As part of fulfillment, I want a direct way to get information from the customer without having to go through their CSM
- As part of fulfillment, I would like to receive any data needed necessary in order to handle the notice to limit back and forth with the customer

User Type 4: Tax Professionals/Senior escalation

- As a tax professional receiving an escalated notice, I want the full resolution history, the actions taken, documents received, and prior communication in the notice record when I take ownership

- As a tax professional, I want to see the notice type, issuing agency, and relevant deadlines immediately so i can assess what agency to contact or response required for resolution.
- As a tax professional, I want a structured escalation note from the fulfillment team explaining what has been attempted and where resolution is stalled.

Business Requirements

1. Notice Intake

1.1 Customer facing upload

- Must have a “Notices” section accessible from the main navigation sidebar (extension of the documents tab).
- Customers must be able to upload a notice as a PDF or image file (JPEG, PNG) from the Notices section.
- On upload, customers must specify the issuing agency from a given dropdown list (IRS, State, Tax Agency, Payroll, Other)
- System will display immediate confirmation on upload: notice received, expected response time, what to expect next in plain language. (”we will work on this in the next blank business days, in the meantime you can track the status)

1.2 Internal

- CSMs can upload a notice on behalf of a customer from the admin interface, without account spoofing AND with account spoofing.
- Admin submitted notices must enter the same intake pipeline as customer submitted notices
- When internally submitted on the admin side by CSM, the submission will include “Submitted by: [CSM name] attribution on record

1.3 Automatic Categorization and Routing

- The system must attempt to automatically (talk to engineering about how feasible this is) classify the notice type from the document content or agency selection on upload
- if classification cannot be determined automatically, the notice is flagged for manual review

2. Customer Facing Status Tracking

2.1 Status

Status	Definition
Received	Notice has been submitted and confirmed in the system
In review	Team member has been assigned and is reviewing the notice
Action needed	team requires addition information or documents from customer
In progress	Actively resolving, document preparation
Escalated	Notice is escalated to a senior tax professional (likely to call agency's to resolve)
Resolved	Notice resolved and resolution sent to customer. easy to understand language summary of what was completed and if anything needs to be done
Closed - No action required	Notice reviewed, no response, action or payment is required from customer. Will still get notified of this case

2.2 Customer Status View

- Customer’s notice dashboard must display all submitted notices with current status, submission date, notice type, and issuing agency
- Each notice entry must be expandable to show the full status history with timestamps
- Status changes will notify the customer in-product as well as email if action is needed from them (sign something, upload more documents)

- “Action needed” status must display a specific prompt with instructions for what the customer must provide and by when.

3. Document Request Flow

- Fulfillment team members must be able to send a document request to a customer directly from within the notice record
- Fulfillment team members must be able to send signature requests to a customer directly from within the notice record
- Document requests must specify: document type (selected from a standardized list to be defined with Operations), plain-language description of why it is needed, and a due date.
- Customers must be able to upload the requested document in direct response to the request, not through the general Document Center.
- Uploaded documents must attach to the notice record automatically and notify the requesting fulfillment team member immediately.
- If a customer does not respond within a defined threshold, the system sends an automated reminder to the customer and notifies the assigned CSM.

4. Internal Work Flow

4.1 Assignment and Queue Management

- On intake, notices must be auto-assigned to a fulfillment queue based on notice type. Team leads must have a manual assignment override.
- Each notice must have a single named owner at all times. Ownership transfers must be logged with actor and timestamp.
- Fulfillment team members must see their assigned notices in a prioritized queue view, sortable by deadline proximity and time in current status.

4.2 Escalation

- Fulfillment team members must be able to escalate a notice to a senior tax professional from within the notice record.

- On escalation, the full notice record, all documents, status history, communications, and fulfillment notes must be visible to the receiving tax professional.
- The escalating team member must be able to add a escalation note describing what has been attempted and where resolution stalled.

5. Notifications

Future Work

List requirements that we know we want to add, but will do later.

Designs

Include designs as necessary.

💡 Type `/figma` or `/invision` to embed any publicly visible files.

Privacy Review

Include any relevant data privacy documentation or note why none is required.

Alternatives Considered

List any alternatives you considered to this solution and why you recommend this solution over the others.

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Related Documents

https://www.figma.com/board/04wa4G5OXgYV7ZGDmLHspu/Swimlane-Diagram-Template--Copy-?node-id=6711-501&t=9hEX4uMJg5LqUfLH-0

Handwritten Notes Diagram

Research notes

Payroll Notices Notes

Follow-up Tasks

What needs to be done next?

Lower the scope, dont neet to change the internal workflow

add pictures and visuals of what we want this to eventually look like